

Playlist Playbook

Every option for getting "Brand New Me" on playlists. What's free, what costs money, and what each one will actually get you. Read it once, run it for 30 days.

4

LANES

\$0–500

BUDGET RANGE

30

DAYS TO EXECUTE

01 — OVERVIEW

The Four Lanes

There are four real paths to playlist placement. Each one costs different amounts of time, money, and effort, and each one delivers different scale. Here's the lay of the land.

LANE	COST	EFFORT	TIME TO RESULT	REALISTIC OUTCOME
Spotify Editorial	FREE	Low	1–2 weeks (post-pitch)	Long shot for indie. Window already missed for this single. Set up for next release.
User-Curated Playlists	FREE	High (manual outreach)	2–4 weeks	5–10 placements out of 50 outreaches. Best ROI for indie.
Paid Submission Services	\$50–\$300	Low (set + forget)	1–7 days	2–10 placements depending on spend. Fastest path.
Christian Radio	FREE	Medium	2–8 weeks	1–3 local TN spins possible. Major networks (K-LOVE) are long shots.

THE MOVE

Run user-curated outreach + a paid SubmitHub blast in parallel. They're the only two lanes that reliably move the needle for an indie artist on his first single. Editorial is set-up-for-next-time. Radio is bonus.

02 — LANE 1

Spotify Editorial Playlists

The big leagues. Spotify-curated playlists like "New Music Friday Christian" or "Country Gospel" can do hundreds of thousands to millions of streams per placement.

FREE · LONG SHOT

The Holy Grail (with a catch)

Free to pitch. Hardest to land. The window for "Brand New Me" already closed.

WHAT IT IS

Editorial playlists are run by Spotify staff. Every Friday they update playlists like "New Music Friday Christian," "Country Gospel," and "Fresh Finds." Getting on one is like having Spotify hand you a megaphone in front of millions of listeners.

HOW TO PITCH

Through **Spotify for Artists** → "Pitch a Song." It's a form: track name, mood, genre, one-paragraph description, hometown, etc. Spotify's editorial team reads them.

THE CATCH

You have to pitch the song **at least 4 weeks BEFORE release date**. For "Brand New Me" that window closed. No way to pitch it now.

FOR THIS SINGLE

Editorial pitch is off the table for "Brand New Me." Don't worry about it for this release.

WHAT TO DO RIGHT NOW

- Complete your **Spotify for Artists profile** 100% — bio, header image, photo gallery, links
- Set **"Brand New Me" as your Artist's Pick** — pinned at the top of your profile
- Add a **Canvas** (8-second looping video) to "Brand New Me" — boosts share rate by 145% per Spotify's data
- Confirm your **artist genres** are tagged correctly (Christian Country, Country, Indie Folk)

FOR YOUR NEXT RELEASE

Pitch via Spotify for Artists **at least 4 weeks before drop date**. This is the single biggest mistake indie artists make. Don't make it again.

REALISTIC OUTCOME

Even with a perfect pitch, editorial placement for an indie artist's first single is a long shot — maybe 1 in 50. But the algorithmic playlists (Discover Weekly, Release Radar) are way more accessible, and they trigger off SAVES not streams. A complete profile + Canvas + Artist's Pick all push you toward those.

03 — LANE 2

User-Curated Playlists

Playlists run by individuals — fans, music nerds, faith-community folks, indie bloggers. Free to pitch. Hands-down the best ROI for an indie artist.

FREE · BEST ROI

Your Bread and Butter

50 outreaches → 5–10 playlist adds → 500–5,000 new streams. Pure sweat equity.

WHAT THEY ARE

Playlists like "Indie Christian Country Vibes" or "Faith & Twang 2026" run by regular people. Some have 500 followers, some have 50,000. They're way more accessible than editorial because they're run by humans you can DM directly.

HOW TO FIND THEM

Five proven methods, in order of best return:

- **"Discovered On" trick** — Go to a similar artist's Spotify page, scroll to "Discovered On" section. Every playlist that added them is a target for you.
- **Spotify search** — search "christian country," "faith country," "indie christian," "country worship," "testimony songs." Filter to user-created playlists with 1K–50K followers.
- **Instagram hashtags** — search #christiancountryplaylist, #faithplaylist, #indiechristian. Curators promote their playlists on IG.
- **Reddit** — r/ChristianMusic, r/Christiancountry. Curators ask for submissions there.
- **TikTok** — many young curators run Spotify playlists and promote on TT. Same hashtags.

REFERENCE ARTISTS TO TARGET

Every playlist that features these artists is a target for you. Mention them in your pitches too — curators trust comparisons.

Josiah Queen

Christian country, blew up on TikTok

Forrest Frank

Indie Christian, testimony-forward

Anne Wilson

Christian country, radio-forward

CAIN

Faith-pop with country edges

Riley Clemmons

Christian indie-pop

Zach Williams

Christian country, testimony-heavy

HOW TO PITCH THEM

Cold DM the curator on Instagram or Twitter. (Curator's social is usually linked in the playlist description on Spotify.) Use the cold DM template at the bottom of this playbook. **Personal beats polished.** Reference a specific song already on their playlist.

CADENCE

5–10 outreaches per day for 7–10 days. Total target: **50 curator DMs**. One follow-up at day 7 if no response. Never nag past that.

REALISTIC OUTCOME

50 outreaches → 10–15% response rate → 5–10 playlist placements over 30 days. If those playlists average 2K followers, that's 500–5,000 new ear-worthy streams plus a permanent track record you can point to in your next pitch.

04 — LANE 3

Paid Submission Services

Pay a small fee, your song lands in front of curators who agreed to listen. Fastest path to placements. Three main services, each with a different angle.

PAID · FAST RESULTS

SubmitHub

Cheapest, biggest network, guaranteed feedback. Start here.

HOW IT WORKS

You buy credits (~\$1 each). Each curator costs 1–4 credits. You submit your song with a 500-character pitch. The curator **MUST** either accept (add to playlist), reject with feedback, or refund your credits. **Feedback is guaranteed** — even rejections come with a comment.

WHAT IT COSTS

- \$50** ~ 50 credits → ~25 submissions → 1–4 placements
- \$100** ~ 100 credits → ~50 submissions → 3–8 placements
- \$200** ~ 200 credits → ~100 submissions → 6–15 placements

PRO TIPS

- Filter to **Christian, Country, Indie, Folk, Americana**. Don't waste credits on mainstream pop curators.
- Sort by **highest approval rate** first, then playlist size 1K–50K followers.
- Look for curators who already added Josiah Queen, Anne Wilson, or Forrest Frank — they're warm leads.
- Lead the pitch with the **emotional hook**, not your bio.

REALISTIC OUTCOME

\$100 spend → 3–8 playlist placements within 7 days, plus written feedback from 40+ curators. Fastest, most measurable lane.

PAID · BLOGS + EU

Groover

Same model as SubmitHub but stronger for blogs, small radio, and European markets.

HOW IT WORKS

Buy "Grooviz" (their currency, ~€1 each). Submit to curators, blogs, radio shows, and labels. Guaranteed feedback within 7 days. If no feedback, you get a refund + bonus credits.

WHAT IT COSTS

- \$30–50** ~ 30–50 submissions → 2–5 placements / blog features / radio spots

BEST FOR

Music blogs (smaller but higher-quality coverage), independent radio shows, and reaching listeners in the UK + EU. Some Christian bloggers are on there too.

REALISTIC OUTCOME

\$40 spend → 2–4 placements + maybe 1 blog write-up. Worth a small test if SubmitHub goes well.

PAID · PREMIUM

PlaylistPush

More expensive, more curated network, higher hit rate per dollar but bigger minimum spend.

HOW IT WORKS

You set a campaign budget. PlaylistPush sends your song to vetted curators. Each curator must rate your song 1–10 and explain why; if they rate 7+ they typically place it. They pre-vet curators harder than SubmitHub.

WHAT IT COSTS

\$300+ minimum for a real campaign. Out of budget for this single — save for a future release.

REALISTIC OUTCOME

Skip for now. The minimum spend eats your whole budget on a single service. Revisit when you have \$500+ to spend on a single track.

05 — LANE 4

Christian Radio

Free to submit, hard to land. Major networks are long shots. Local Tennessee stations are way more winnable and they still feed listeners straight to your Spotify.

FREE · LONG GAME

The Bonus Lane

Don't expect K-LOVE on track #1. Expect a couple of local TN spins if you pitch right.

MAJOR CHRISTIAN NETWORKS (LONG SHOTS)

- **K-LOVE** — submit via klove.com/music. Major network, very competitive.
- **Air1** — submit via air1.com. K-LOVE's sister network, slightly more open to indie.
- **WAY-FM** — submit via wayfm.com. Smaller national network, more accessible.

LOCAL TN STATIONS (WAY MORE WINNABLE)

- **WCRV (Memphis)** — Christian talk + music
- **WJAC (Cookeville area)** — local, smaller, way more accessible
- **WBOZ "94 FM the Fish" (Nashville)** — Christian contemporary
- **Local Christian college radio** — Trevecca Nazarene, Lipscomb, Lee University
- **Cookeville-area country stations** — pitch as a hometown story, not a religious play

HOW TO PITCH

Email the music director directly (find on station website). Use the radio email template at the bottom of this playbook. Attach a one-sheet PDF if you have one. Local angle wins — "Cookeville, TN artist" is a hook.

REALISTIC OUTCOME

1–3 local TN spins are achievable if you pitch 10–15 stations. Major network play on track #1 is unlikely but possible. Everything you land becomes a credibility hook for the next pitch.

06 — BONUS

Hidden Lanes Most Artists Miss

Three additional ways to get your song in front of listeners that don't fit the standard playlist pitch playbook.

BONUS · FREE

Spotify Algorithmic Playlists

Discover Weekly, Release Radar, Daily Mix. The algorithm decides — and it cares about SAVES, not streams.

These auto-generated playlists pull in 60–70% of all indie playlist traffic. The algo triggers off **save rate**, **completion rate**, and **share rate** — NOT raw stream count.

How to push it:

- Personally text/DM 50 friends + church + family with the Spotify link. Ask them to **save** the song (not just listen).
- Make sure your "Brand New Me" Canvas video is set up — Spotify boosts tracks with Canvas.
- Anyone who follows you on Spotify gets the song in their Release Radar automatically. Push for follows.

BONUS · FREE

TikTok-to-Spotify Pipeline

Many TikTok creators run their own Spotify playlists. Two birds, one DM.

If a TikTok creator (especially in faith/country space) features your song, ask them to add it to their Spotify playlist too. Most have one. This is how songs cross from TT virality → permanent stream catalog.

BONUS · FREE

Apple Music for Artists

Same playbook as Spotify, smaller audience but less competition.

Sign up for Apple Music for Artists (free). Pitch through their dashboard for editorial. Their Christian + country editorial team is genuinely more open to indie artists than Spotify's. Lower volume but worth 30 minutes of setup.

How to Spend \$200

Recommended allocation from your \$100–500 budget. Optimized for maximum placements per dollar.

\$100

SUBMITHUB

100 credits → ~50 submissions to vetted curators.
Highest-volume lane.

\$40

GROOVER

~40 submissions for blogs + small radio + EU
curators. Test spend.

\$60

RESERVE

For tipping curators who accept, or doubling down
on what's working in week 3.

\$0

COLD OUTREACH

User-curated DMs + radio emails cost nothing but
time. Run in parallel.

The 30-Day Plan

Week-by-week cadence. Don't skip the foundation week — it makes every other lane work harder.

WEEK 1 · DAYS 1–7

Foundation + Target List

- ☐ Complete Spotify for Artists profile (bio, header, gallery, Canvas)
- ☐ Set "Brand New Me" as Artist's Pick
- ☐ Set up Apple Music for Artists account
- ☐ Build curator target list — 50 user-curated playlists with contact info
- ☐ Create SubmitHub account, buy 100 credits
- ☐ DM/text 50 personal contacts asking them to SAVE the song on Spotify

WEEK 2 · DAYS 8–14

Outreach Push

- ☐ SubmitHub blast — submit to 50 curators (Christian, Country, Indie, Folk filter)
- ☐ Cold DM 5–10 user-curated playlist owners per day on IG
- ☐ Email 5–10 local TN radio stations + 3 major Christian networks
- ☐ Test Groover with \$40 spend
- ☐ Track everything in a simple spreadsheet (sender, date, response)

WEEK 3 · DAYS 15–21

Follow-Ups + Momentum

- ☐ Single follow-up DM to anyone who didn't respond at day 7
- ☐ Read SubmitHub feedback — apply learnings to your next pitch round
- ☐ Thank-you message + ask-for-share to anyone who placed your track
- ☐ Screenshot every playlist add → post to IG/TT stories ("just got added to X playlist")
- ☐ Use early traction ("featured on 5 playlists in week 2") in next round of pitches

WEEK 4 · DAYS 22–30

Double Down + Plan Next Release

- ☐ Spend reserve \$60 on whatever lane is winning
- ☐ Build relationships with curators who placed your track — they're your warm list for next release
- ☐ Set calendar reminder for next single: pitch via Spotify for Artists 4 weeks before drop
- ☐ Document what worked in a one-page recap → applies to every future release

09 — TEMPLATES

Pitch Templates

Three versions, copy-paste-ready. Replace the highlighted bits with the specifics for the playlist or station you're pitching.

COLD DM · FOR USER-CURATED PLAYLIST OWNERS

Hey [name], been listening to [their playlist name] — [specific track on their playlist] has been on repeat for me.

I'm Blaine, just released "Brand New Me," a Christian country track about coming out of a season of shame. For fans of Josiah Queen, Zach Williams, Anne Wilson.

[Spotify link]

Would mean a lot if you gave it a listen for the playlist. Either way, appreciate the work you're doing.

— Blaine (BL4INE.)

SUBMITHUB · 500-CHARACTER PITCH

Christian country testimony track about coming out of a season of shame. Fully indie, fully written and sung by me.

Quotable line: "I think this time it's safe to say, I finally made it to the other side of shame."

For fans of Josiah Queen, Forrest Frank, Zach Williams.

Doing 2K+ streams in week 1 as an independent artist with 60 TikTok followers — there's a real audience pull on this one. Appreciate the listen either way.

RADIO EMAIL · FOR CHRISTIAN + LOCAL TN STATIONS

Subject: New Christian country release — "Brand New Me" by BL4INE.

Hi [music director name] ,

Reaching out about a new Christian country track from independent Tennessee artist BL4INE. (William Blaine Smith).

"Brand New Me" released April 20, 2026 — a testimony track about coming out of a season of shame. For fans of Josiah Queen and Anne Wilson.

Spotify: [link]

Artist profile: [link]

Would love consideration for rotation.

Thanks,

[your name]

10 — ROLES

Who Does What

Clear division of labor. Vantage handles the heavy lifting on the technical pitching side. You handle the human side and the song-promotion content.

VANTAGE CO. HANDLES

The Pitch Engine

- ✓ Build the curator target list (50 playlists with contact info)
- ✓ Run the SubmitHub + Groover campaigns end-to-end
- ✓ Draft + send the radio outreach emails
- ✓ Track responses in a shared spreadsheet
- ✓ Recap report at end of 30 days

YOU HANDLE

The Human Side

- ✓ Personally DM/text 50 contacts asking for Spotify SAVES (not just streams)
- ✓ Complete your Spotify for Artists profile (bio, photo, Canvas)
- ✓ Send the cold DMs to user-curated playlist owners — these convert way better when they come from you, not a marketing team
- ✓ Post a screenshot to IG story every time a playlist adds your song
- ✓ Thank curators publicly when they place your track

THE ONE THING TO REMEMBER

Spotify's algorithm cares about *saves*, not *streams*. Every "save" from a real human is worth ~10x a passive stream. The fastest way to land on Discover Weekly and Release Radar isn't a viral playlist — it's getting 200 real people to hit the save button. Start there.

